



FUNCTIONALITY OF TOURMAP

TourMap is a free GPS-based mobile app that enhances the exploration of urban history and culture. When users enter a city, the app can identify their location and highlight nearby historical attractions, such as ancient buildings and churches. It will also recommend cultural landmarks like museums and art galleries with visiting information. For free or public attractions, TourMap offers historical videos and related cultural content. Users can explore different thematic based on their interests, such as war history or notable figures. The app also supports multiple languages in order to help travellers understand local culture more easily.

The concept of TourMap is based on Manovich's (2006) theory of augmented space, which refers to layering digital information onto physical places. This allows users to explore streets and landmarks while receiving visual and audio guidance. The app also includes real-time comments and pop-ups. Visitors can share experiences and travel tips while exploring. This is inspired by Gay's (2009) example of MobiTags in museums, which helps users to explore museum in an interactive way. TourMap also use the same function, making visitors not just "visitors", but co-constructors. The features encourage users to engage with places and contribute to the shared cultural memory of the city.

TARGET USERS OF TOURMAP

TourMap's target audience is travellers aged 18 to 40, who are typically highly educated and possess strong cultural literacy. This age group is generally tech-savvy and comfortable using digital tools for travel planning. The app is suitable for users across all income levels, including both domestic residents and international tourists interested in cultural exploration. According to Statistics Canada (2024), Canadian residents made over 330 million trips in 2024, and young adults aged 18 to 40 were the most active travel group (Flight Centre, 2024).

These users seek meaningful, culture-rich travel experiences. In fact, 31% of Canadian travellers in 2024 identified exploring local culture and heritage as their main travel purpose (Abacus Data, 2024). They prefer self-guided, immersive journeys and enjoy using pop-up features to access cultural insights and share their experiences throughout the trip.

USER BARRIERS OF TOURMAP

- **Device limits:** Some users may lack high-performance phones or stable networks.
- **Unfamiliarity with technology:** Some users may not be familiar with interactive technology or may resist using it.
- **Privacy concerns:** Since the app requires real-time location access, some users may worry about privacy and data security.
- **Cultural understanding barriers:** Even with multilingual support, some local historical or cultural content may be difficult for foreign users to fully understand.
- **Limited coverage:** In cities where TourMap's database is incomplete, users may lose interest due to the lack of available information.
- **Information overload:** Too many features or pop-ups may overwhelm users and reduce usability.

USER MOTIVATIONS FOR TOURMAP

- **Interest in cultural exploration:** Users are curious about culture and history, seeking educational journeys.
- **Enhanced travel experience:** Videos, text, and pop-ups make users engage, even with unfamiliar content.
- **Personalized exploration paths:** Customizable routes based on personal.
- **High digital acceptance:** Digitally fluent users are eager to try interactive tools, outweighing technology unfamiliarity.
- **Need for social interaction:** Real-time comments and sharing features strengthen connection and reduce travel isolation.
- **Cross-cultural communication support:** Multilingual and video features reduce cultural barriers and help users' understanding of unfamiliar content.

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